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General Comment

The emergence of generative neural network models has seen a large shift in society. In particular, there has been a large amount of friction between creative artists of all stripes, whether visual, musical, vocal, or otherwise and the major players behind generative neural networks.

The friction is based on the fact that the companies have been downloading and using any materials available to them to train their various models. They do not seek permission and do not offer compensation to those whose materials they use. These models then go on to compete directly with those people it was trained from in a commercial setting.

In essence, a competitor to smaller artists is using their own copyrighted materials against them in a commercial activity without permission, attribution, or compensation. This directly threatens the livelihood of these people and flies directly in the face of Fair Use and copyright protection.

The companies will tell you their models can change the world and understand things. This is based on nothing. Nothing in the way these neural networks are trained leads to comprehension. Most commercial models are little more than extremely advanced phone predictive text.

The easiest way to see through this veneer is through what the companies term hallucinations, when these networks will make a prediction that is presented as factual or real, but is in reality just a false prediction. There is no compensating for this error and the reliability of all models is suspect at best. This has been seen across scientific and legal communities most notably, where hallucinated references to papers and legal decisions have cropped up and caused issues on many occasions.

A product that is built on mass theft, which markets itself as intelligent while not being able to truly think, and that seems to compete with those it has stolen from is wildly out of line. These companies need to be reigned in and need to train their networks on works they have the rights to. There are people willing to give their works for training, for compensation.

If a company cannot exist without massive theft, it should not exist. Changing copyright to allow for rich competitors to bully out smaller artists will set arts back in the country and the world by decades, if not more.